

Vincent Nania

UX Strategist, Design Leader and Mentor

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EXPERIENCE

Lead Experience Design Strategist

Verizon · 2024 – Present

- Lead the strategic transformation of the My Verizon app, redefining the top-level dashboard as a pathfinder into deeper account, billing, and device flows, driving a 60% monthly engagement lift and a 4.7-star App Store rating (4.8 on Google Play).
- Operationalize the "Skim, Dip, Dive" framework into a governance model teams use to arbitrate top-level feature placement, protecting clarity across 10M+ ecosystem impressions and 1M+ unique sub-visits.
- Lead and develop a team of 3 designers, providing ongoing feedback, mentorship, and creative exercises, and coaching them to communicate and grow within a large corporate organization.
- Win product and business buy-in by mapping the entire legacy app and website against the framework, screen by screen, replacing opinion debates with evidence.
- Resolve stakeholder disputes with working prototypes that show how an experience feels, not just how it looks in a static Figma screen.
- Secure design system exceptions through side-by-side component demos; customized patterns ship and are appended to the global library.

Senior User Experience Architect

American Eagle Outfitters · 2022 – 2024

- Led 0-to-1 service design for Buy Online, Pick Up In-Store across digital and store operations, launching to 1,000+ stores in the U.S. and Canada and generating \$51.4M in revenue at an 84% fulfillment rate.
- Replaced the failing Reserve, Try, Buy program (69% abandonment, 223K uncollected units) with an end-to-end pickup experience grounded in shopalongs, associate interviews, and a five-layer service blueprint.
- Aligned 20+ stakeholders across 9 teams on one unified direction; piloted in four stores ahead of holiday and converted live operational feedback into shipped design fixes.
- Pitched and built a zero-budget conversational FAQ that cut chat contacts 18% and total contacts 8% at \$5.00 saved per deflected chat, securing funding for a fully integrated in-house assistant.
- Led 2 UX designers with direction, feedback, and oversight while partnering directly with the CTO and SVP of E-Commerce.

SKILLS

Product Strategy

Experience Strategy

Service Design

Design Systems

AI-Augmented Design

Agentic Product Design

Conversational UX

Information Architecture

Customer Journey Architecture

Governance Frameworks

Product and Interaction Design

Rapid Prototyping

User Research

Usability Testing

A/B Testing

Behavioral Insights

Data Analysis and Metrics

Content Strategy

Cross Functional Alignment

Executive Storytelling

Workshop Facilitation

Design Mentorship

Team Leadership

Senior User Experience Designer

American Eagle Outfitters · 2019 – 2022

- Lead UX designer and researcher for cart, checkout, chatbot, account management, BOPIS, returns, instant credit, fulfillment, self-service and help experiences.
- Conducted story mapping, stakeholder interviews, customer diary studies, customer journey mapping, in-store shop-alongs and usability testing.
- Conducted qualitative usability tests, collaborated with UX researchers on longitudinal studies and utilized quantitative data tools to uncover actionable insights.

Founder and UX Lead

UX For Equality · 2020 – 2022

- Founded a pro bono UX practice for Black-owned businesses; recruited and led a volunteer research team.
- Ran moderated, task-based usability tests with think-aloud protocol, then presented findings and recommendation decks to founders over Zoom.
- Delivered prioritized UX and build recommendations to each business, and in a couple of cases implemented the changes in the client CMS.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

User Experience Designer

American Eagle Outfitters · 2016 – 2019

- UX designer and researcher for alternative payments, returns research, transactional communication and personalization.

User Experience Designer

Giant Eagle, Inc. · 2015 – 2016

- UX designer and researcher for online grocery ordering and fulfillment; built and managed a comprehensive design pattern library standardizing UI components across products.

Mobile App Designer and Researcher

University of Pittsburgh · 2014 – 2015

- Designed and researched CourseMIRROR, a mobile app surfacing student feedback to professors via natural language processing; co-authored a published research paper.

Human Capital Management Intern

Goldman Sachs · Summer of 2010

- Coordinated the securities division new hire training program and workforce diversity initiatives.

CERTIFICATIONS

UX Design Leadership · UXcel, June 2024 · ID: 8PPGNS44MEOY

Design Mentorship Mastery with ADPList · UXcel, March 2024 · ID: X5UOTCMQHOOR

AI in UX/UI Design · UXcel, February 2024 · ID: ZNTCNNESAS3D

EDUCATION

Master of Science

Human-Centered Computing

University of Pittsburgh

2014 – 2015

Bachelor of Science, Psychology

University of Pittsburgh

2010 – 2013

SUMMARY

Design strategist focused on simplifying complex ecosystems at enterprise scale. Experienced in aligning cross functional teams, shaping structural frameworks, and delivering measurable impact across digital platforms.